

AUTO TICKET CLASSIFICATION USING FLOW DESIGNER

ServiceNow Project Documentation

A no-code approach for automatically classifying school IT support tickets and notifying callers after ticket creation.

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1. Problem Statement

A school IT helpdesk receives a steady flow of support requests from students and teachers. Typical requests include Wi-Fi connectivity problems, projector issues, forgotten passwords, and computers that are slow or unresponsive. In the existing process, IT staff review each request manually, determine the type of issue, and select the appropriate category and subcategory. As the number of tickets increases, this approach can consume considerable time and may lead to inconsistent classification.

The proposed solution uses ServiceNow Flow Designer to classify newly created tickets automatically. The flow checks keywords in the short description and assigns the relevant category and subcategory without requiring the IT agent to perform the classification manually.

2. Project Objectives

- Automatically classify IT support tickets when they are created.
- Reduce the amount of manual work required from IT support staff.
- Improve the routing and consistency of incoming tickets.
- Use a no-code implementation that is straightforward to maintain and extend.
- Provide an automated email acknowledgement to the caller after ticket creation.

3. Requirement Analysis and Planning

The helpdesk process was reviewed to identify the information that needs to be captured and the actions that should happen automatically. A ticket may relate to network connectivity, hardware, account access, or system performance.

The system is designed to support the following business requirements:

1. Classify an IT ticket according to the issue described by the requester.
2. Populate both Category and Subcategory automatically.
3. Maintain a dependency between Category and Subcategory so that the available subcategories match the selected category.
4. Send an email notification to the caller when the ticket is created.
5. Store ticket information in a consistent and structured format.
6. Keep the configuration simple enough for future maintenance and extension.

4. Update Set Configuration

A dedicated update set is used to group the configuration changes made for the project. This makes the customization easier to track and move to another environment.

7. Open All and search for Update Sets.
8. Under System Update Sets, open Local Update Sets.
9. Select New.
10. Enter Project Update Set as the Name.

11. Set State to In progress.
12. Set Application to Global.
13. Save the record.
14. From the Related Links section, select Make This My Current

The top screenshot shows the ServiceNow interface with a search for 'LOCAL UPDATE' in the 'Build Agent' section. The search results show 'Local Update Sets' under 'System Update Sets'. A red box highlights the search results area.

The bottom screenshot shows the 'Update Set - Project Update Set' form. The form fields are as follows:

Field	Value
Name	Project Update Set
State	In progress
Application	Global
Created	2026-09-28 02:05:01
Created by	admin
Merged to	
Parent	
Release date	
Install date	
Installed from	
Description	

A red box highlights the Name, State, and Application fields. Below the form, there is an 'Update' button and a 'Related Links' section with links to 'Merge With Another Update Set' and 'Scan Update Set'. At the bottom, there is a 'Customer Updates (49)' section with tabs for 'Update Set Logs', 'Child Update Sets', and 'Install History'.

Table - Incident WorkFlow

Application: Global

Remote Table:

Column label	Type	Reference	Max length	Default value	Display
Updated by	String	(empty)	40		false
Category	String	(empty)	40		false
Number	String	(empty)	40	javascript:global.getNextObjNumberPadded();	false
Created by	String	(empty)	40		false
Updated	Date/Time	(empty)	40		false

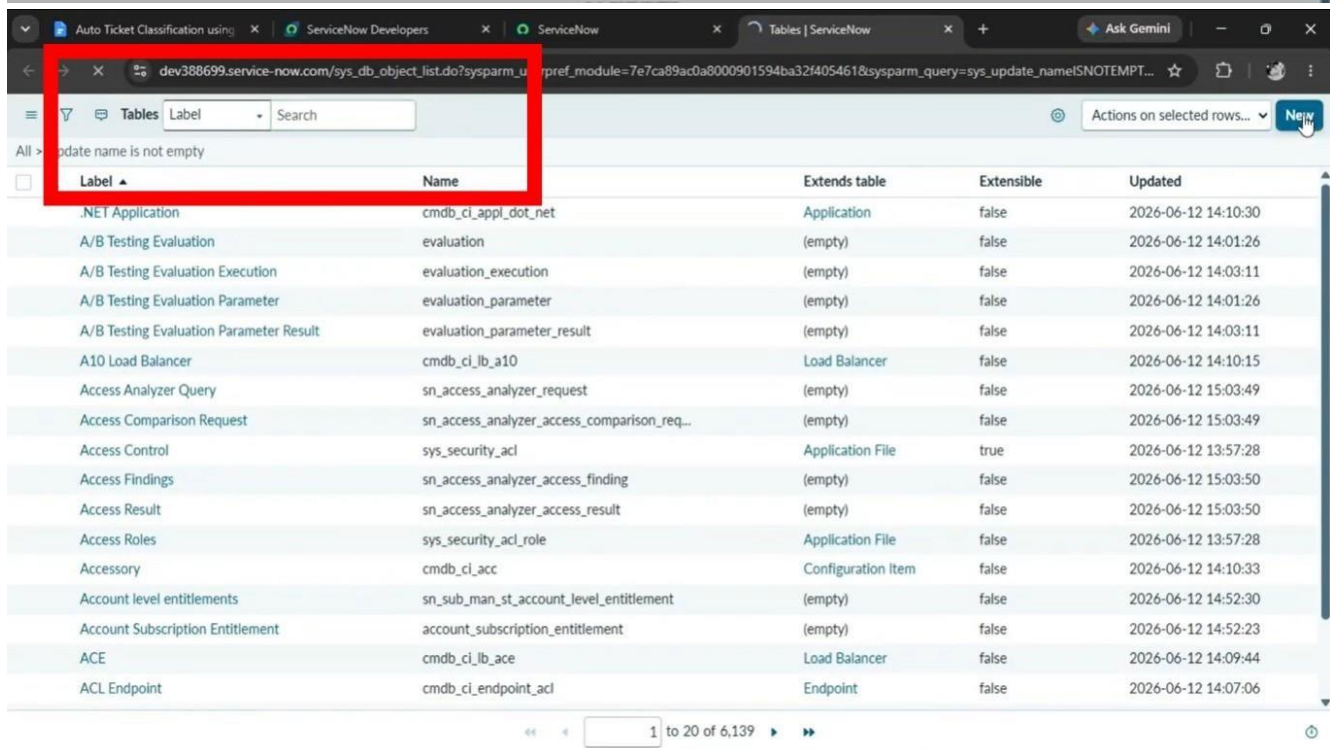
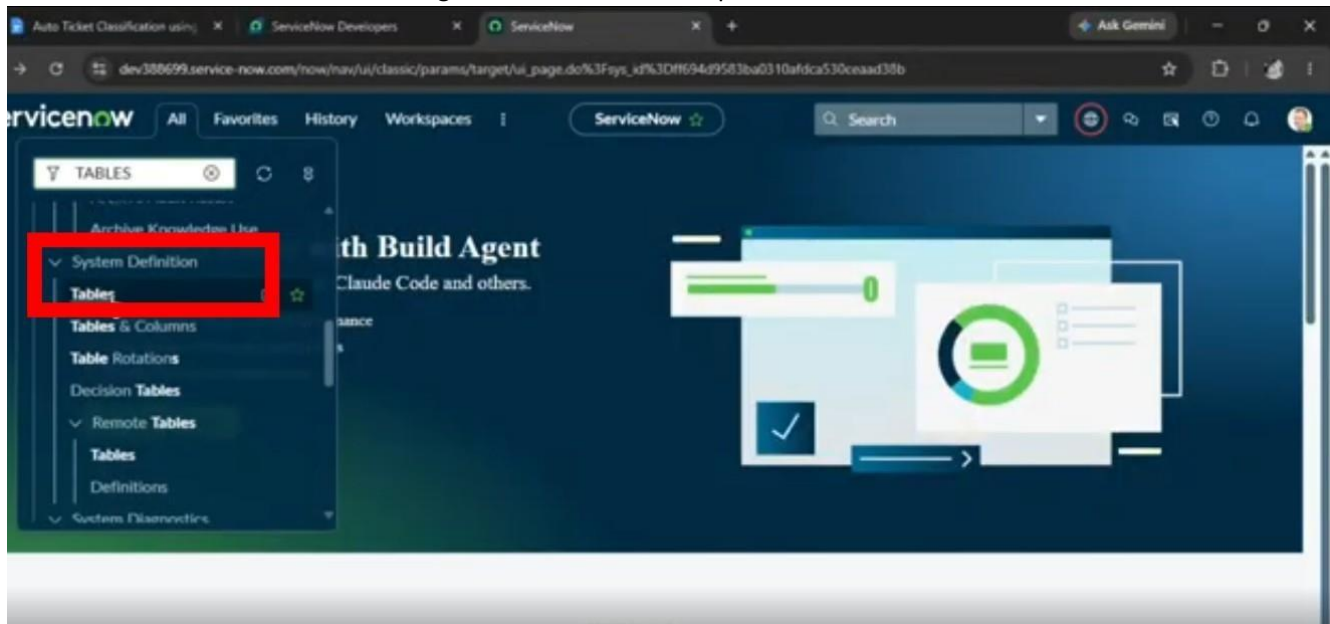
5. Backend Development and Configuration

5.1 Creating the Custom Table

A custom table is created to hold the school IT ticket records. The table is configured with an auto-number field so that each ticket receives a unique identifier.

15. Open All and search for Tables.

16. Under System Definition, select Tables.
17. Click New.
18. Set the Label to Incident WorkFlow.
19. Clear the Create module option.
20. Save the table.
21. Open the Controls section.
22. Enable the Auto Number option.
23. Save the table again.
24. Use the table form and Form Designer to add the fields required for the ticket record.



The screenshot shows the ServiceNow 'Table' configuration page for 'u_incident_workflow'. The top section, highlighted with a red box, contains the following fields:

- Label:** Incident WorkFlow
- Name:** u_incident_workflow
- Extends table:** (empty)
- Application:** Global
- Create module:** ☐
- Remote Table:** ☐

The bottom section, also highlighted with a red box, shows the 'Auto-number' configuration:

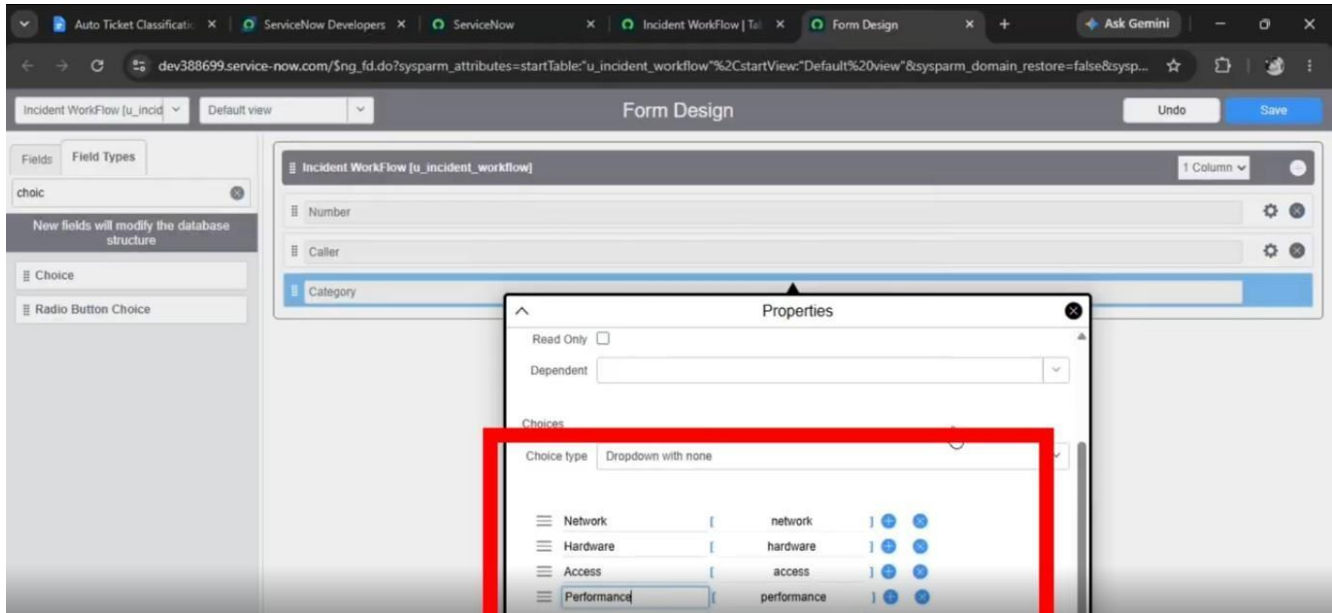
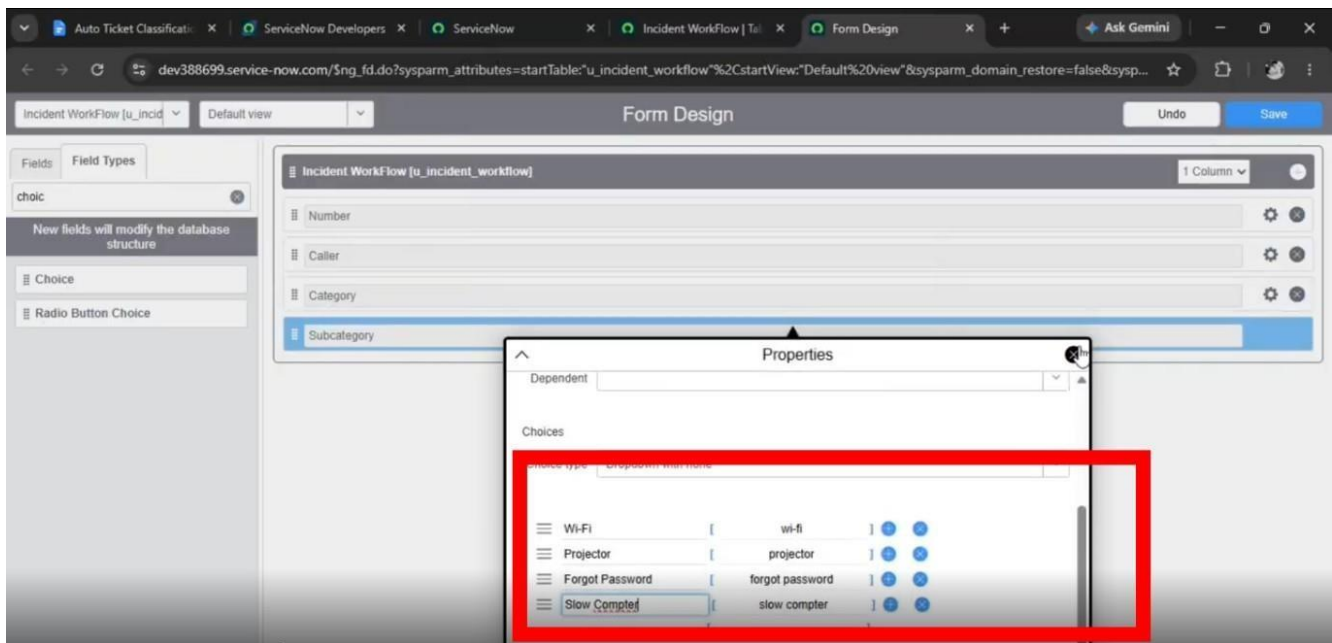
- Auto-number:** ☒
- Prefix:** INC
- Number:** 1000
- Number of digits:** 7

5.2 Ticket Field Configuration

The ticket table contains fields for identifying the requester, describing the issue, classifying the ticket, and tracking its assignment and state.

Field	Type	Reference / Choices
Number	Auto Number	—
Caller	Reference	sys_user
Category	Choice	Network, Hardware, Access, Performance
Subcategory	Choice	Wi-Fi, Projector, Forgot Password, Slow Computer
Short Description	String	—
Description	String	—
State	Choice	New, In progress, On hold, Resolved, Closed
Assigned Group	Reference	sys_user_group
Assigned to	Reference	sys_user

Choice values are added to Category, Subcategory, and State. After the fields and choices are configured, the form is saved and reloaded so the updated configuration is available.

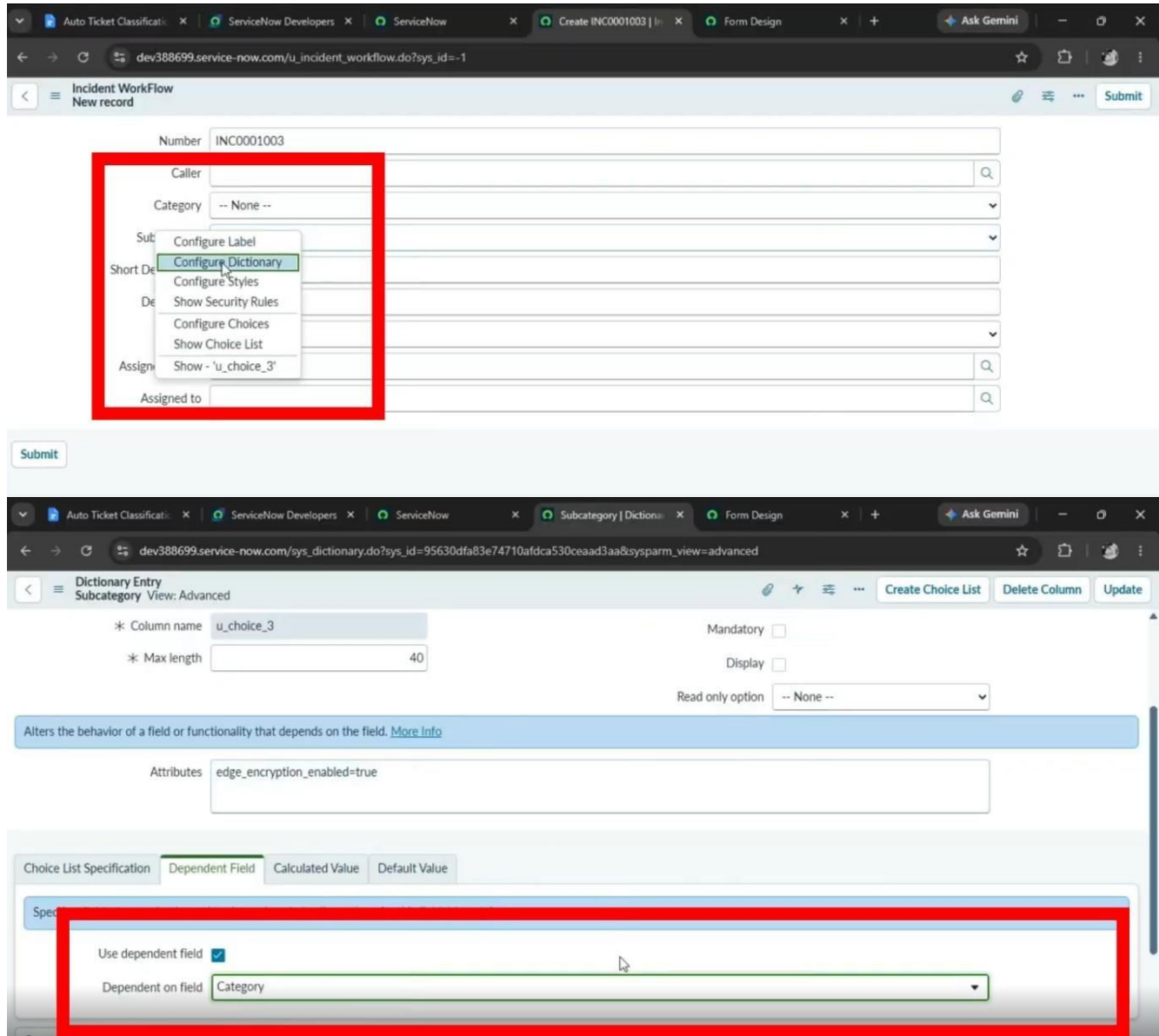


6. Category and Subcategory Dependency

The Subcategory field is configured as a dependent choice field. This ensures that the subcategory options are associated with the appropriate Category.

25. Open the Incident WorkFlow form.
26. Right-click the Subcategory field and select Configure Dictionary.
27. Open the Advanced view from Related Links.
28. Locate the Dependent Field section.
29. Enable Use dependent field.
30. Select Category in the Dependent on field.
31. Save the dictionary configuration.

32. In the choice section, associate each subcategory with the corresponding category backend value.



The dependency mapping used by the project is:

Subcategory	Category
Wi-Fi	Network
Projector	Hardware
Forgot Password	Access
Slow Computer	Performance

Auto Ticket Classification: x ServiceNow Developers x ServiceNow x Subcategory | Dictionary x Form Design x + Ask Gemini

dev388699.service-now.com/sys_dictionary.do?sys_id=95630dfa83e74710afdca530ceaad3aa&sysparm_domain=null&sysparm_domain_scope=null&sysparm_view=...

Dictionary Entry
Subcategory View: Advanced*

Use dependent field ☒

Dependent on field Category

Create Choice List Delete Column Update

Related Links
[Show Table](#)
[Run Point Scan](#)

Access Controls Choices (4) Attributes (1) Labels (1)

Label Search

Choices

	Label	Value	Language	Sequence	Inactive	Updated	Dependent value
☐	Forgot Password	forgot password	en	2	false	2026-09-28 20:49:52	Access
☐	Wi-Fi	wi-fi	en	0	false	2026-09-28 20:49:51	Network
☐	Slow Computer	slow computer	en	3	false	2026-09-28 20:49:52	Performance
☐	Projector	projector	en	1	false	2026-09-28 20:49:51	Hardware

Insert a new row...

Actions on selected rows... New

Auto Ticket Classification: x ServiceNow Developers x ServiceNow x Create INC0001004 | Form Design x + Ask Gemini

dev388699.service-now.com/u_incident_workflow.do?sys_id=-1

Incident Workflow
New record

Submit

Number INC0001004

Caller

Category Network

Subcategory -- None --

Short description -- None --

description Wi-Fi

State -- None --

Assigned Group

Assigned to

Submit

Incident WorkFlow
New record

Number: INC0001004

Caller: [Search]

Category: Hardware

Subcategory: -- None --

Short Description: Projector

Description: [Text Area]

State: -- None --

Assigned Group: [Search]

Assigned to: [Search]

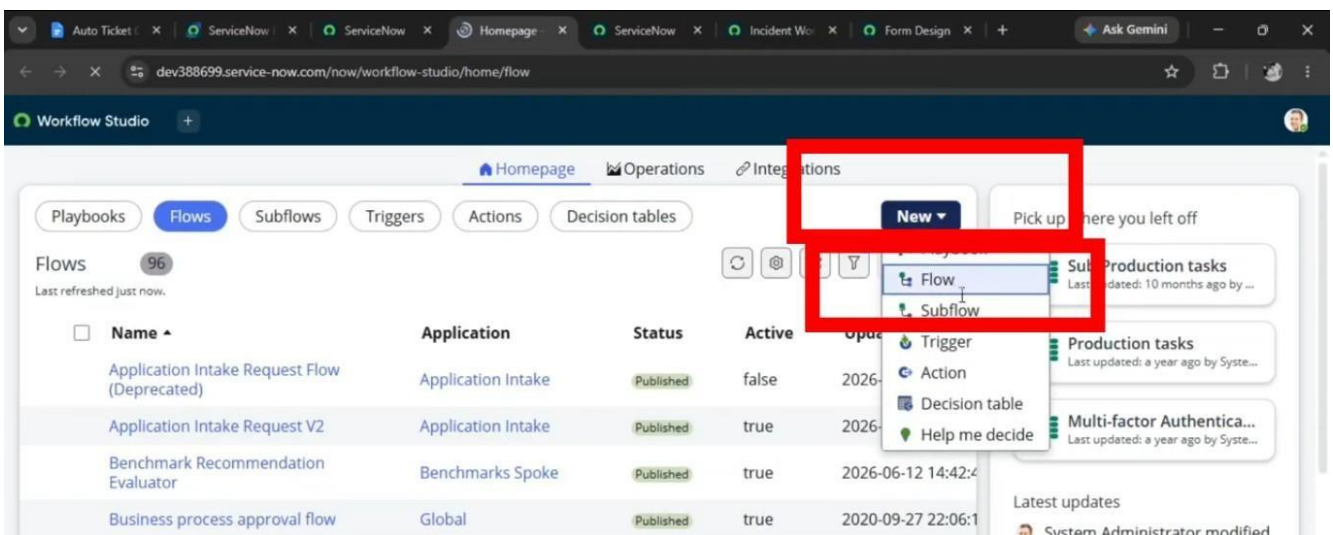
Submit

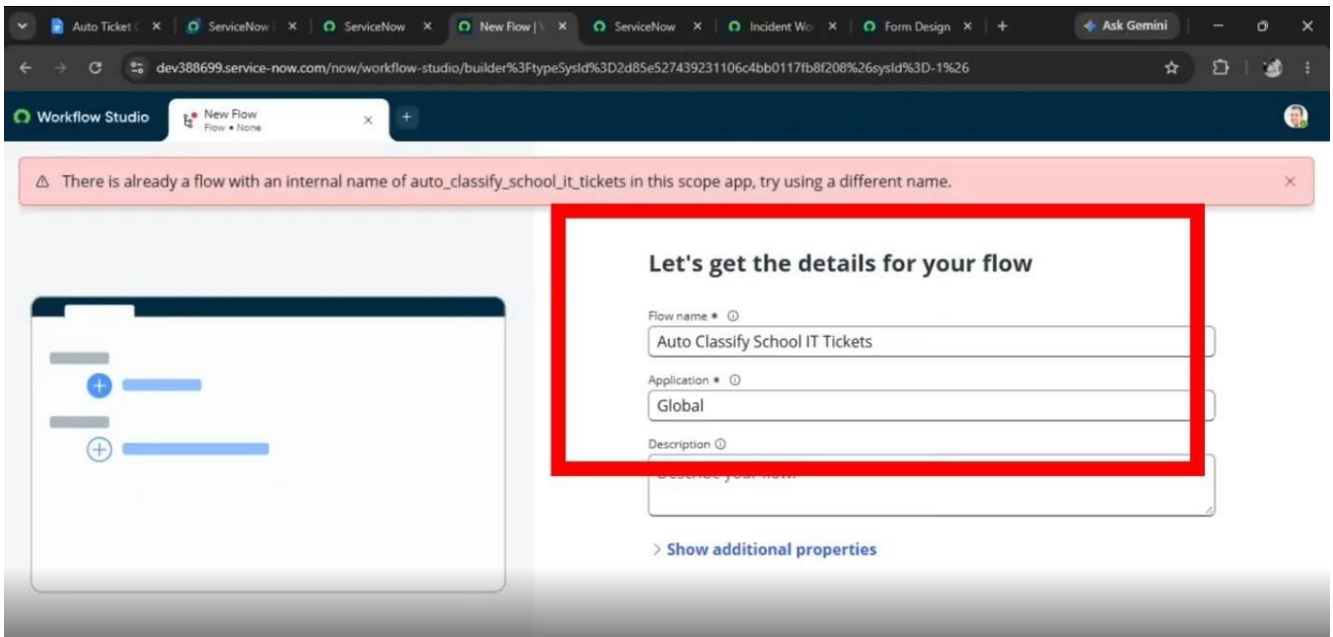
7. Automation with Flow Designer

The main automation is implemented in Flow Designer. When a new ticket is created, the flow checks the short description for predefined keywords. Depending on the keyword found, the flow updates the Category and Subcategory fields. After classification, an email is sent to the caller.

7.1 Create the Flow

33. Open All and search for Flow Designer.
34. Under Process Automation, open Flow Designer.
35. Select New and choose Flow.
36. Set the flow name to Auto Classify School IT Tickets.
37. Set Application to Global.
38. Select Build Flow.



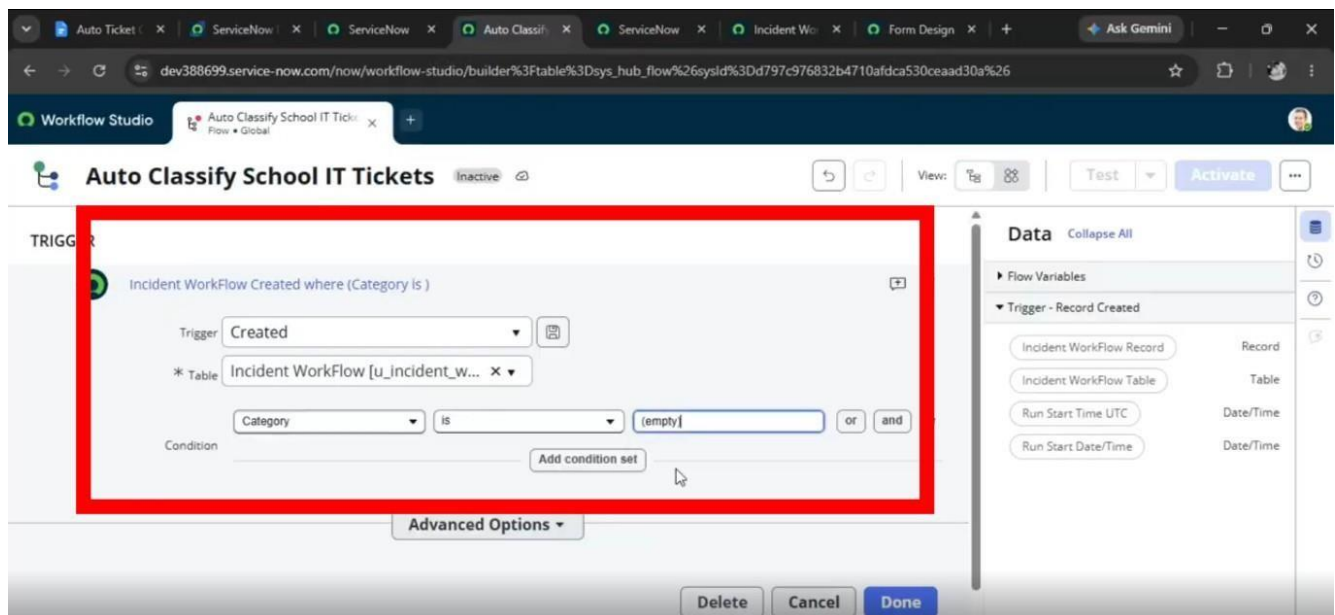


7.2 Configure the Trigger

Use the following trigger configuration:

- Trigger: Record Created
- Table: Incident Workflow
- Condition: Category is empty

Select Done after configuring the trigger.



7.3 Wi-Fi / Network Classification

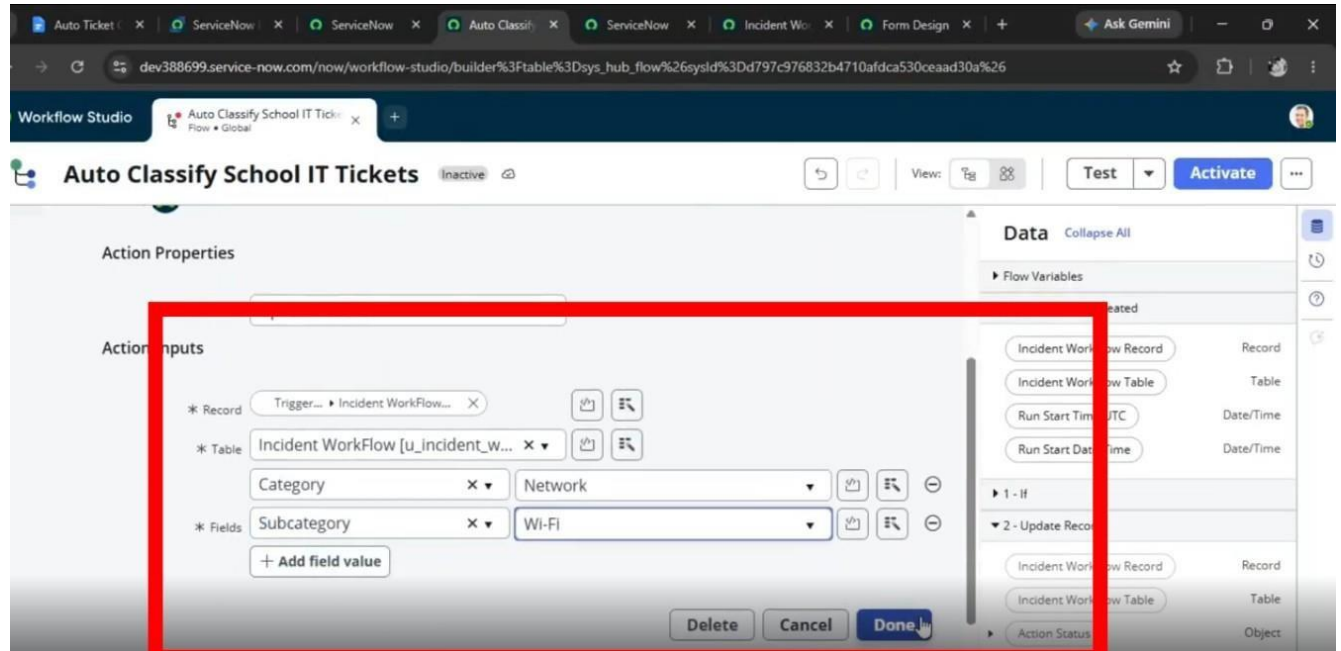
The first condition checks whether the Short Description contains either Wi-Fi or Network.

- Condition type: If

□

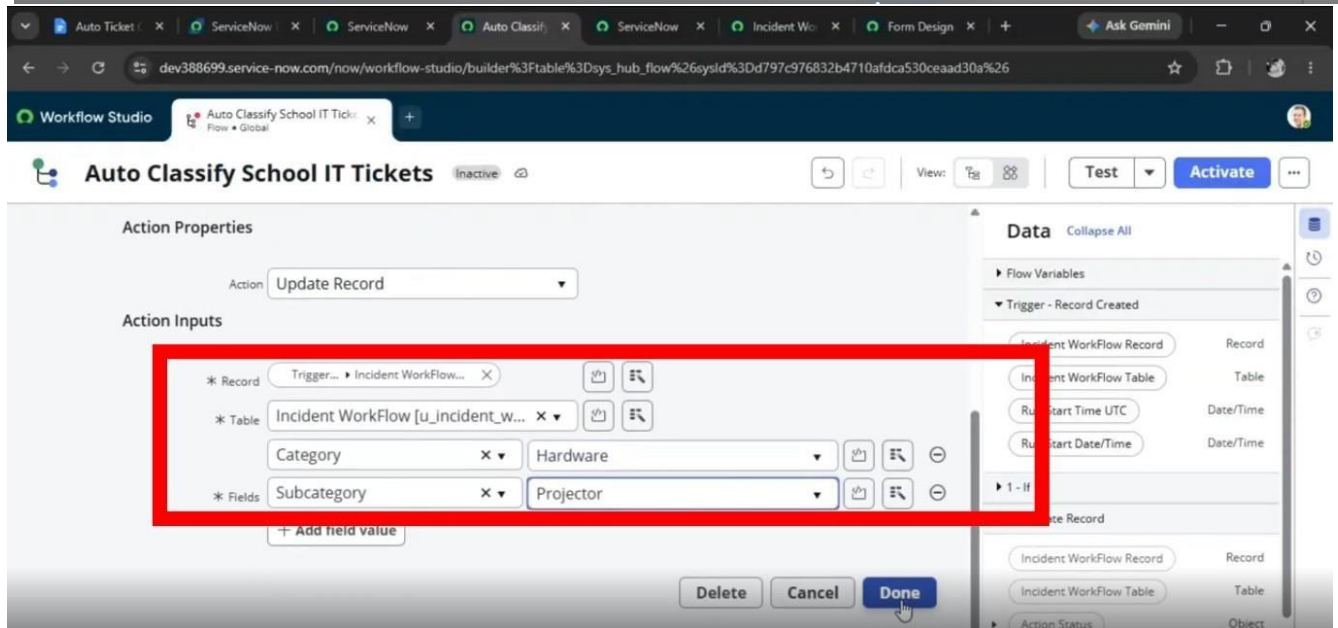
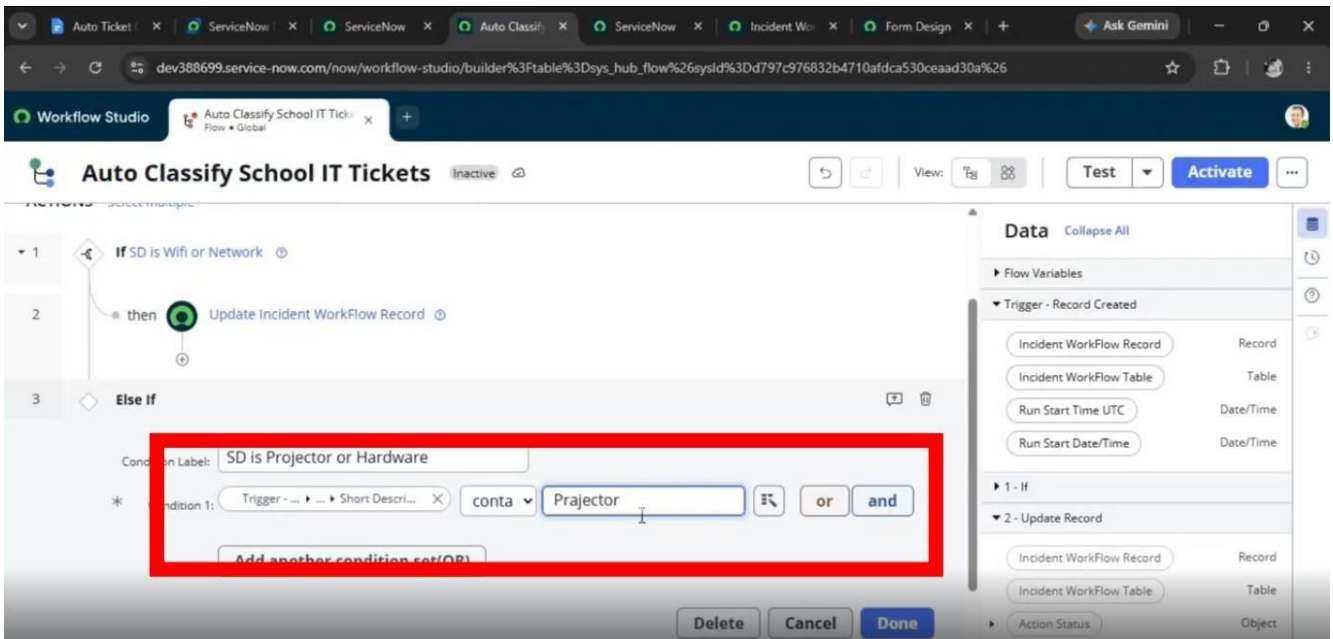
Condition label: SD is WiFi or Network

- Short Description contains: Wi-Fi
- Short Description contains: Network
- Action: Update Record
- Category: Network
- Subcategory: Wi-Fi



7.4 Projector Classification

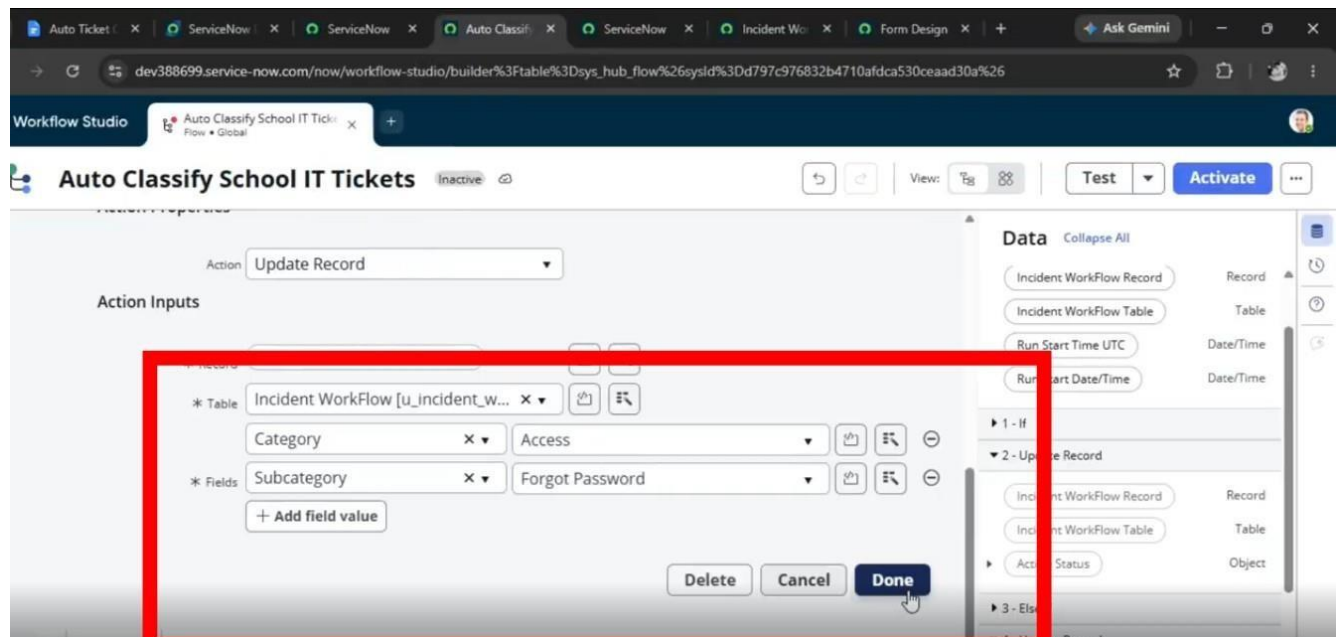
- Condition type: Else If
- Condition label: SD is Projector or Hardware
- Short Description contains: Projector
- Action: Update Record
- Category: Hardware
- Subcategory: Projector



7.5 Password / Access Classification

- Condition type: Else If
- Condition label: SD is Forgot Password
- Short Description contains: Forgot password
- Action: Update Record
- Category: Access

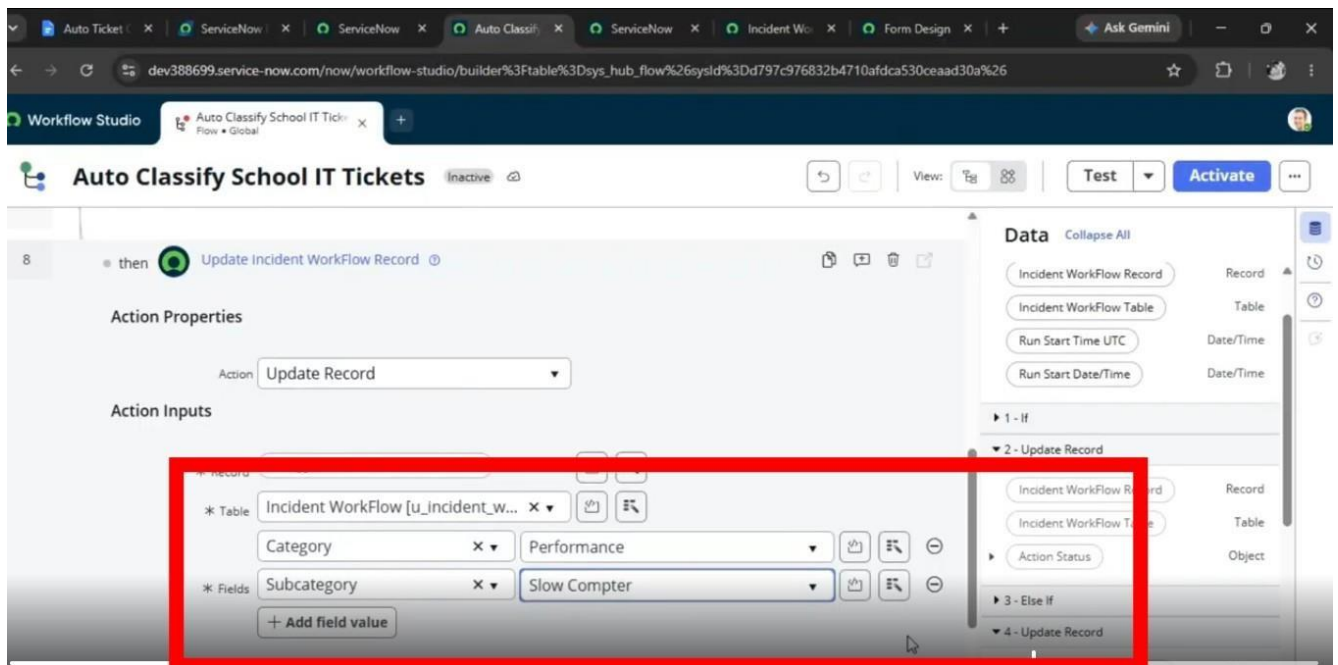
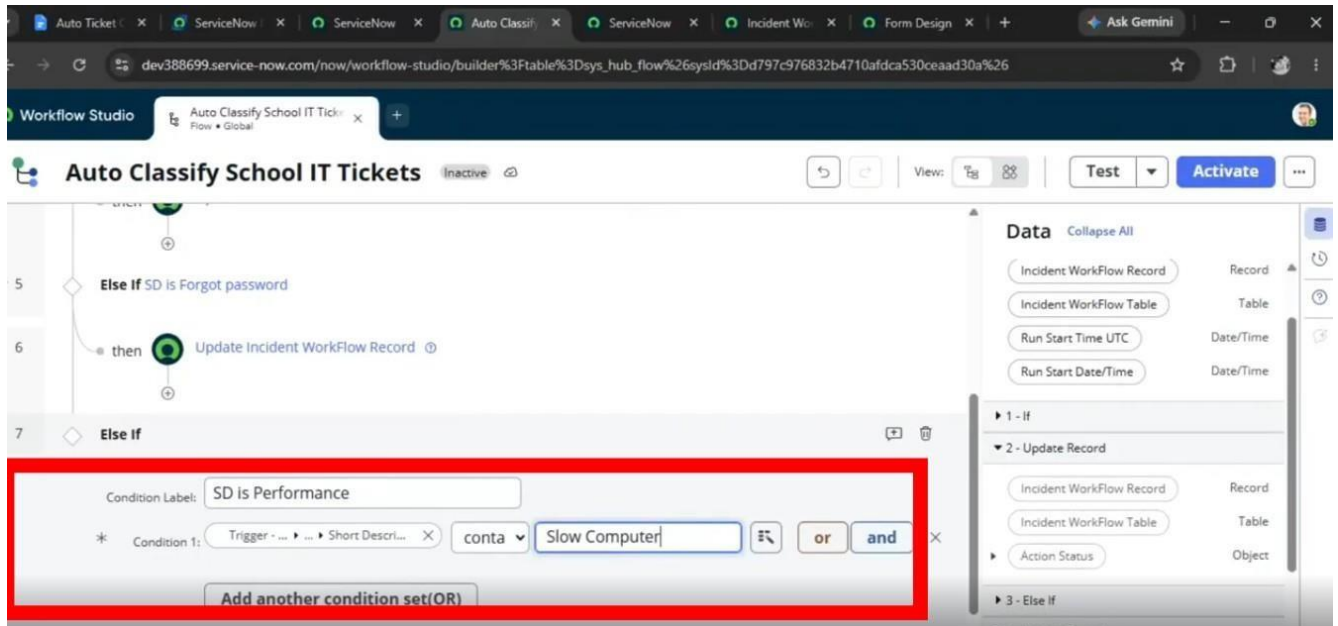
□



7.6 Slow Computer Classification

- Condition type: Else If
- Condition label: SD is Performance
- Short Description contains: Slow Computer
- Action: Update Record
Category: Performance

- Subcategory: Slow Computer



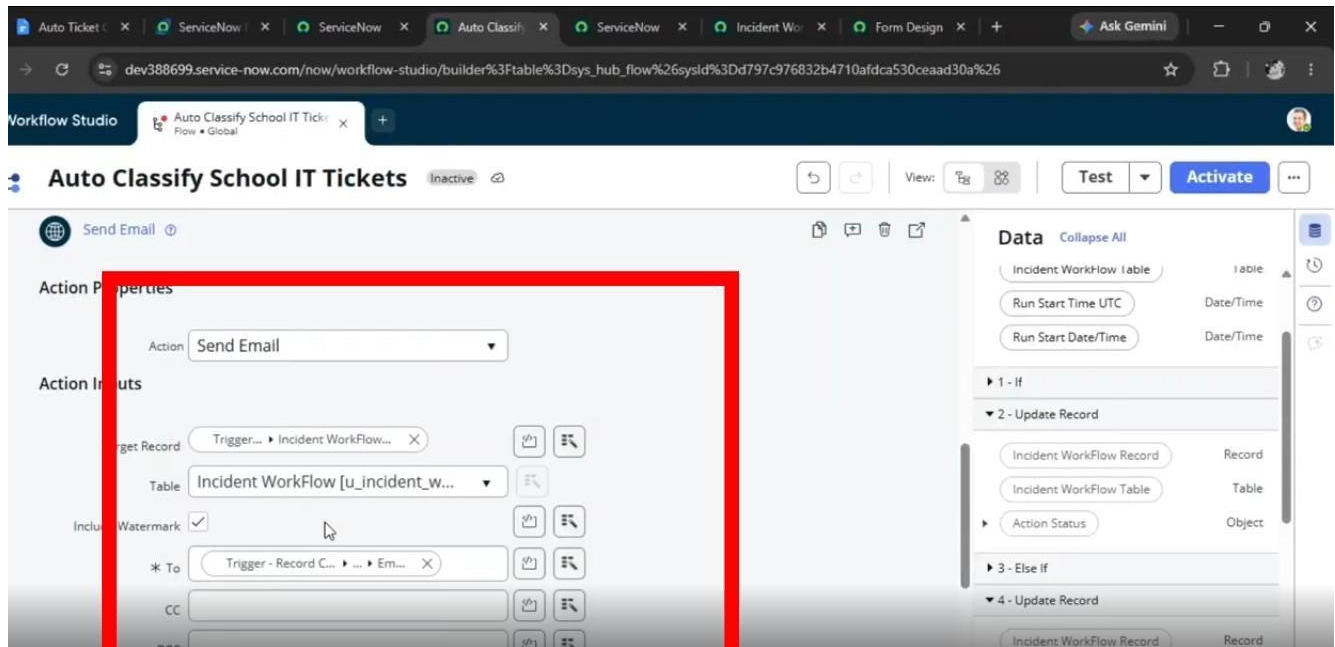
7.7 Email Notification

After the ticket is classified, the flow sends an email confirmation to the caller.

- Action: Send Email
- To: Caller → Email
- Subject: Your Request for the issue has been submitted.
- Body: Ticket confirmation message

□

Once all conditions and actions are configured, save the flow and select Activate.



8. Testing, Validation and Security

The solution is tested end-to-end to confirm that ticket data is stored correctly, classification occurs as expected, and the caller receives the notification.

8.1 Validation Checks

- Required ticket information is captured correctly.
- The ticket number is generated without duplication.
- Category and Subcategory values are populated correctly

Number	Category	Subcategory	State	Caller	Assigned Group	Assigned to	Short Description	Description
INC0001017	Network			Abel Tuter	(empty)	(empty)	My college has issue with Network	
INC0001011				Abraham Lincoln	(empty)	(empty)	Network Issue	
INC0001010				Abraham Lincoln	(empty)	(empty)	Network issue	
INC0001004	Hardware			(empty)	(empty)	(empty)		
INC0001018	Network			Abel Tuter	(empty)	(empty)	My college has issue with Network	
INC0001016	Network			Abraham Lincoln	(empty)	(empty)	My college has issue with network	
INC0001007	Network			Abel Tuter	(empty)	(empty)		
INC0001008				Abraham Lincoln	(empty)	(empty)	Network Issue	
INC0001009				Abraham Lincoln	(empty)	(empty)	Network issue	
INC0001012				Abraham Lincoln	(empty)	(empty)	Network issue	

□

- Reference fields resolve to the appropriate user and group records.

Number: INC0001018

Caller: Abel Tuter

Category: Network

Subcategory: Wi-Fi

Short Description: My college has issue with Network

Description:

State: None

8.2 Test Scenario 1 – Wi-Fi Issue

- Enter a Caller.
- Set Short Description to: WiFi not working in library.
- Save the form.
- Reload the form.
- Verify Category is set to Network.

44. Verify Subcategory is set to WiFi.
45. Verify that an email is sent to the caller's email address.

8.3 Verify the Email

46. Open All and search for Emails.
47. Under System Logs, select Emails.
48. Search using the configured subject.
49. Open the corresponding email record.
50. From Related Links, select Preview mail to review the generated message.

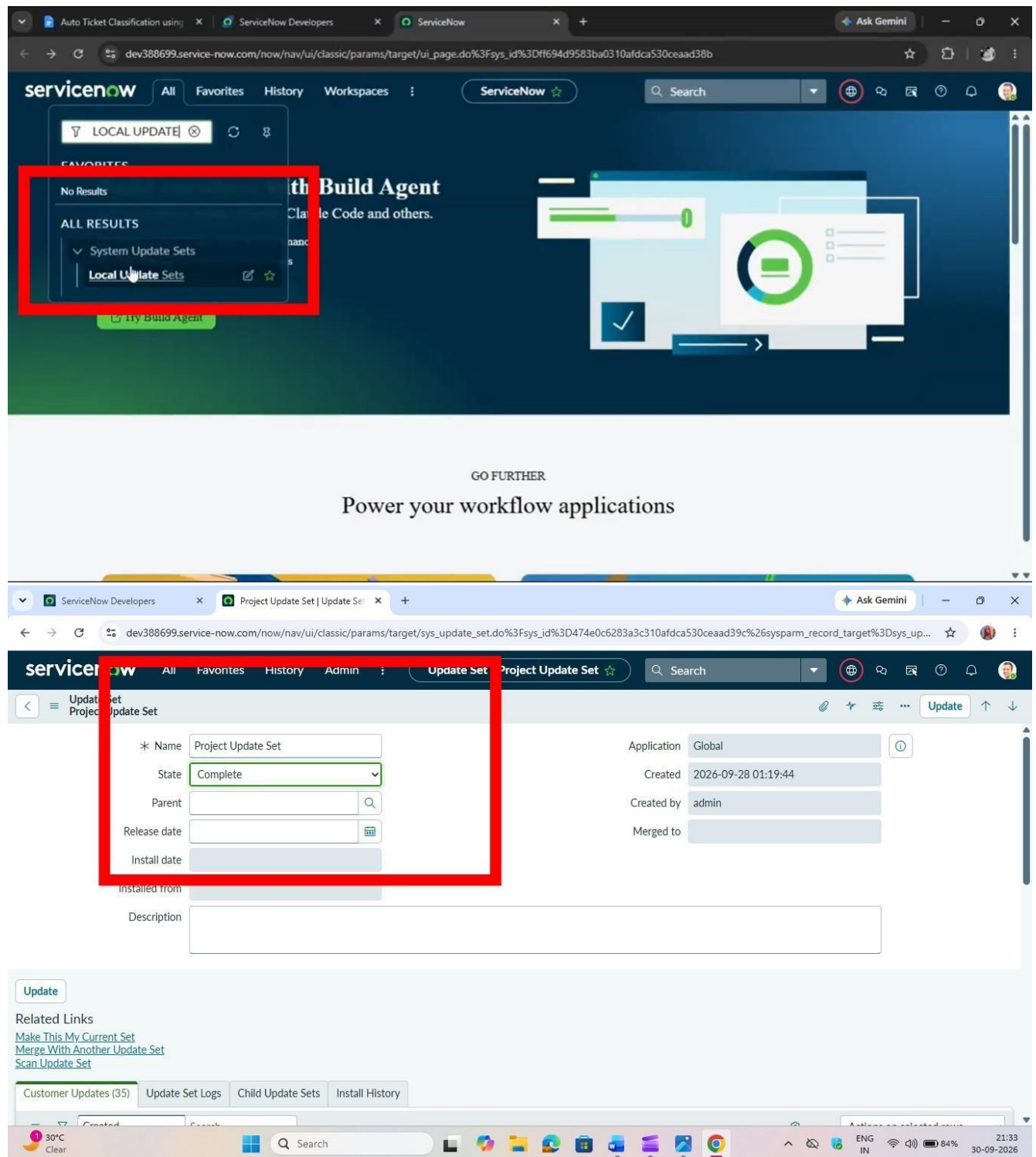
8.4 Test Scenario 2 – Projector Issue

51. Enter a Caller.
52. Set Short Description to: Projector not turning on.
53. Save the form.
54. Reload the form.
55. Verify Category is set to Hardware.
56. Verify Subcategory is set to Projector.
57. Verify that an email is sent to the caller's email address.

9. Deployment and Final Documentation

After testing is complete, the project update set is moved to the Complete state and exported so the configuration can be transferred to another ServiceNow environment.

58. Open All and search for Local Update Sets.
59. Under System Update Sets, select Local Update Sets.
60. Open Project Update Set.
61. Change State from In progress to Complete.
62. Save the record.
63. From Related Links, select Export to XML.
64. Save the exported XML file for transfer or sharing.



10. Conclusion

The Auto Ticket Classification using Flow Designer project provides an end-to-end approach for handling common school IT support requests. Instead of requiring support staff to classify every new ticket manually, the configured flow identifies predefined keywords in the ticket description and assigns the corresponding Category and Subcategory.

The dependent choice configuration helps keep ticket data consistent, while the automated email action provides immediate confirmation to the caller. The use of Flow Designer keeps the solution within a no-code configuration model and makes the workflow easier to maintain.

The project also includes validation scenarios for Wi-Fi and projector issues, along with email verification and update-set deployment steps. The same design can be extended later with additional classification conditions, assignment automation, SLA tracking, or other ServiceNow capabilities.

DEMO LINK: <https://drive.google.com/file/d/1Os3sGGsKMznoOV38jNjz1LbgOf1S4IRK/view?usp=drivesdk>